
A diagram showing a vertex labeled v at the bottom. Two lines enter the vertex from above: a dashed line on the left labeled $\backslash$ and a solid line on the right labeled $/$.

true knowledge of reality (tattva-jñāna)

- > false notion removed (mithya-jnana)
- > defects cease (dosa: raga, dvesa, moha)
- > activity ceases (pravrtti) -> birth ceases (janma)
- > suffering ceases (duhkha) -> RELEASE (apavarga)

ANSWER RULE: name the half the question sits in before writing a single doctrine.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/15: Sixteen topics of inquiry and twelve knowables

NIYAYA 16 – ANATOMY OF A DISPUTE, NOT AN INVENTORY OF BEING

BLOCK I APPARATUS

1 means of valid knowledge (pramana) 2 objects of valid knowledge (prameya)

BLOCK II RUNNING AN INQUIRY FROM DOUBT TO VERDICT

3 doubt (samsaya) 4 purpose (prayojana) 5 accepted example (drstanta)

6 established doctrine (siddhanta) 7 members of demonstration (avayava)

8 hypothetical reasoning (tarka) 9 ascertainment (nirnaya)

BLOCK III THREE STYLES OF DISPUTE

10 truth-directed debate (vada) | 11 victory-directed wrangling (jalpa)

12 destructive cavil (vitanda)

BLOCK IV FOUR MODES OF FAILURE

13 fallacious reason (hetvabhasa) 14 quibble (chala)

15 futile rejoinder (jati) 16 ground of defeat (nigrahasthana)

! HOMONYM TRAP: jati = futile rejoinder HERE; jati = universal in Vaisesika.

|
v

TOPIC 2 OPENS INTO 12 KNOWABLES – A SOTERIOLOGICAL SEQUENCE, NOT AN ONTOLOGY

self -> body -> senses -> sense-objects -> cognition -> sensory mind (manas)

-> activity -> defects -> rebirth -> fruit -> suffering -> release

Vaisesika's categories fall WITHIN this field of knowables but keep their own ownership and structure.

! NEVER MERGE 16 + 7 INTO ONE LIST OF 23.

tarka = AID to the instruments (pramana-anugrahaka), never an instrument.

its unacceptable-consequence forms: self-dependence (atmasraya), mutual

dependence (anyonyasraya), circularity (cakraka), infinite regress

(anavastha), contradiction of perception or inference.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/15: Seven categories – substance, quality, motion

Atishay (अतिशय) = "The meaning of a word" = whatever is nameable and knowable

1 SUBSTANCE (dravya) 2 QUALITY (guna) 3 MOTION (karma)

4 UNIVERSAL (samanya) 5 ULTIMATE PARTICULARITY (visesa)

6 INHERENCE (samavaya) 7 ABSENCE (abhava)

? Kanada's older list is commonly taken as SIX, absence added later as seventh.

NINE SUBSTANCES, SORTED BY THE TESTS EXAMINERS USE

ATOMIC + build the gross world : earth (prthivi) | water (ap) | fire (tejas)
| air (vayu)

ALL-PERVADING, ETERNAL, ONE : ether (akasa, substrate of sound)
| time (kala) | direction (dik)

KNOWER AND ITS INSTRUMENT : self (atman) eternal, all-pervading, MANY
| mind (manas) eternal, ATOMIC, one per self

! TRAP: ether, time and direction ARE substances, not abstract frameworks.

! mind atomic => ONE cognition at a time; deep sleep = conjunction withdrawn.

TWENTY-FOUR QUALITIES (guna) – dependent, inhere in substance

colour | taste | smell | touch | number | magnitude | distinctness

conjunction | disjunction | priority | posteriority | cognition | pleasure

pain | desire | aversion | effort | heaviness | fluidity | viscosity

dispositional tendency (samskara) | merit (dharma) | demerit (adharma) | sound

! cognition, pleasure, desire, merit, demerit are QUALITIES OF THE SELF,
not its essence and not a separate category.

FIVE MOTIONS (karma) = PHYSICAL, not moral karma

upward | downward | contraction | expansion | locomotion

motion -> CONJUNCTION and DISJUNCTION (themselves qualities) -> CAUSATION

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/15: Universal, six blockers, ultimate particularity

THE OPPOSITE PUZZLES, ONE ONTOLOGY

SAMENESS: black cow + white calf are both "cow" -> UNIVERSAL (samanya/jati)

DIFFERENCE: two atoms alike in every respect are TWO -> PARTICULARITY (visesa)

UNIVERSAL: real, eternal, ONE-IN-MANY, present by INHERENCE (not spatial split)
ordered higher (para) / lower (apara) by extension

ARGUMENT: real classification needs an objective ground; resemblance is always
resemblance IN SOME RESPECT -> presupposes realist semantics

RIVAL: Buddhist EXCLUSION (apoha) – "cow" = "not non-cow" (Dignaga/Dharmakirti)

REPLY: universals ARE presented in determinate (savikalpaka) perception;
exclusion presupposes stable exclusion-classes

SIX BLOCKERS OF UNIVERSALHOOD (jati-badhaka) = SIX REFUSAL TESTS

1 no single instance (vyakter abhedah) ether-ness blocked

2 co-extensiveness (tulyatvam) pot-ness vs jar-ness

3 cross-cutting (sankarah) elemental-ness vs corporeal-ness

4 infinite regress (anavastha) universal-ness blocked

5 form-loss (rupahanih) a universal in particularities

6 no available relation (asambandhah) inherence-ness blocked

BLOCKED CANDIDATE -> survives only as IMPOSED PROPERTY (upadhi), not a category
=> the realism is REGULATED; this answers the charge of ontological excess

ULTIMATE PARTICULARITY (visesa): individuates ETERNAL substances only

atoms of the four elements + ether, time, direction, self, mind

composites need none (parts, qualities, place, causal history individuate them)

WITHOUT IT: exactly similar eternal collapse by identity of indiscernibles

OBJ regress of differentiators -> REPLY self-differentiating (svato-vyavartaka)

OBJ imperceptible IOU -> REPLY posited INFERENTIALLY (Nyaya reduces postulation
(arthapatti) to inference, so no smuggled fifth instrument)

! RESIDUE: "self-differentiating" NAMES the terminus, does not prove it.

Srihasa's Khandanakhandakhadya attacks Nyaya definitions systematically.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/15: Inherence versus conjunction – the table test

Q(c) (i) remove the colour -> no table of that kind => INSEPARABLE (ayutasiddha)

(ii) remove the book -> table survives => SEPARABLE (yutasiddha)

CRITERION = ONTOLOGICAL INSEPARABILITY, NOT closeness or physical grip

FEATURE	INHERENCE (samavaya)	CONJUNCTION (samyoga)
ontological rank	a CATEGORY in its own right	a QUALITY (one of 24)
relata	inseparable	separable
production	eternal as a relation	produced + destructible
number	ONE, not locally multiplied	many, one per contact
access	imperceptible, inferred	effects evident
example	colour in cloth; whole in parts	book on table; two pots in contact

FIVE INHERENCE PAIRS

whole <- parts | quality <- substance | motion <- substance

universal <- particular | particularity <- eternal substance

2021 Q5(c) VERDICT: inseparability (ayuta-siddhatva) is NECESSARY but NOT BY ITSELF SUFFICIENT as a defining characteristic (laksana).

definitional faults to name: too narrow (avyapti) | too wide (ativyapti)

| impossible (asambhava). Inseparability alone risks being TOO WIDE.

safe formula = inseparability + the specific ontological dependence of the dependent term on its locus.

OBJ relation-regress (anavastha) -> REPLY self-linking relation

(svarupa-sambandha); relates by its own nature, needs no further relator

! RESIDUE: a stipulated terminus; critics note Nyaya uses regress as a weapon (blocker 4) while claiming immunity here.

ONE OR MANY? one and eternal, for parsimony. Difficulty: why does one relation tie THIS quality to THIS substance? Reply: the relata determine its operation.

STRONGEST PRO-INHERENCE ARGUMENT: conjunction is itself a QUALITY and must inhere, so conjunction PRESUPPOSES inherence and cannot replace it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/15: Absence – four kinds, structure, cognition

COUNTERPOSITIVE (pratiyogin). No counterpositive => no negation.

FOUR KINDS AND THEIR EXACT TEMPORAL SIGNATURES

PRIOR (pragabhava) NO BEGINNING, HAS AN END (ends at production)

POSTERIOR (pradhvamsa-) .. HAS A BEGINNING, NO END (begins at destruction)

ABSOLUTE (atyantabhava) .. NEITHER BEGINNING NOR END – hare's horn

MUTUAL (anyonyabhava) DIFFERENCE, not temporal – "a pot is not a cloth"

2023 Q5(d) DECODE THE PRINTED STATEMENT IN TWO CLAUSES

"negation always has a counterpositive" -> negation has determinate content

"absolute negation is an impossibility" -> CONTENTLESS negation is impossible

! THIS DOES NOT DENY ABSOLUTE ABSENCE (atyantabhava), an admitted kind.

2024 Q5(c) THE DISCRIMINATION, DRAWN

"AIR DOES NOT HAVE HEAT" locus air | counterpositive HEAT = a QUALITY

-> denies a QUALIFICATION -> ABSOLUTE ABSENCE

"AIR IS NOT FIRE" locus air | counterpositive FIRE = a SUBSTANCE

-> denies an IDENTITY -> MUTUAL ABSENCE

TEST: is the missing item a QUALITY that could qualify the locus (absolute)

or ANOTHER ENTITY the locus might be identified with (mutual)?

2018 Q5(d) HOW ABSENCE IS KNOWN – THREE POSITIONS

NYAYA : perceived through the QUALIFIER-QUALIFIED relation
(visesana-visesya-bhava), the SIXTH sense-object contact.

4 conditions: object would be perceptible if present | locus
available | senses competent | no obstruction.

If the missing item is inferential, its absence is inferred.

NO independent instrument of non-cognition is admitted.

BUDDHIST : no separate negative entity; positive locus + non-apprehension,
conceptual exclusion or inference

BHATTA MIMAMSA : NON-COGNITION (anupalabधि) as an INDEPENDENT instrument

=> the disagreement is ONTOLOGICAL before it is EPISTEMOLOGICAL

2019 Q5(a) JUSTIFICATION IN FOUR STEPS

determinate negative cognition -> realist semantics -> explanatory work

(prior absence defeats the pre-existent effect) -> economy (one category,

four kinds, no new instrument). ? concede the six/seven enumeration.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/15: Four instruments and Gautama's definition

ONE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa) ... each one in the previous one's limit

PERCEPTION (pratyaksa) ... gives the object itself, directly
INFERENCE (anumana) reaches what is out of sensory range
COMPARISON (upamana) fixes the word-object link
TESTIMONY (sabda) reaches what no individual could verify
COUNT CAUTION: 4 = NYAYA. classical Vaisesika = 2. synthesis follows Nyaya.
NYAYA REDUCES: postulation (arthapatti) -> inference;
 non-cognition (anupalabdhi) -> perception or inference.
NOT instruments: MEMORY (reproductive) | TARKA (aid only)

GAUTAMA'S DEFINITION (2025 Q6(a)) AS FOUR EXCLUSION GATES
indriyārtha-sannikarsa-utpannam jñanam avyapadesyam avyabhicari
vyavasayatmakam pratyaksam

GATE 1 produced from SENSE-OBJECT CONTACT -> EXCLUDES inference, memory,
 testimony; marks perception as the foundational instrument

GATE 2 NON-VERBAL (avyapadesya) EXCLUDES testimony
 ! does NOT mean inexpressible; determinate perception is expressible

GATE 3 NON-ERRANT (avyabhicari) EXCLUDES illusion (shell-silver)
 => creates the DEBT that the theory of error must discharge

GATE 4 DETERMINATE (vyavasayatmaka) EXCLUDES doubt ("post or man?")
 ? tension with the admitted INDETERMINATE (nirvikalpaka) phase.
 standard reading: the clause excludes DOUBT, not the pre-predicative
 stage. critics: one word doing two jobs.

INDETERMINATE (nirvikalpaka) -> DETERMINATE (savikalpaka) "this is a blue pot"
the determinate stage is where the UNIVERSAL appears as qualifier => this is
the epistemology behind realism about universals.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/15: Six contacts and three extraordinary perceptions

BY SENSE-OBJECT CONTACTS (samikara) – EACH REACHES A DIFFERENT OBJECT

- 1 conjunction (samyoga) a SUBSTANCE: the pot
 - 2 inherence-in-conjoined its QUALITY or MOTION: its colour
(samyukta-samavaya)
 - 3 inherence-in-inherent-in-conjoined the UNIVERSAL in that quality:
(samyukta-samaveta-samavaya) colour-ness
 - 4 inherence (samavaya) SOUND, inhering in ether
 - 5 inherence-in-inherent (samaveta-samavaya) SOUND-NESS
 - 6 qualifier-qualified (visesana-visesya-) ABSENCE: jar-absence on the table
- => 3 and 5 carry "universals are perceived"; 6 carries absence-cognition

THREE EXTRAORDINARY PERCEPTIONS (alaukika) – TWO ARE LOAD-BEARING

UNIVERSAL-MEDIATED (samanyalaksana-pratyaksa)

perceiving an instance of smokeness relates the knower to SMOKE AS SUCH

-> the specifically Nyaya solution to INDUCTION (see Panel 10)

COGNITION-MEDIATED (jñanalaksana-pratyaksa)

a prior cognition mediates present perception; sandalwood "seen" as fragrant

-> the mechanism of the THEORY OF ERROR (see Panel 11)

YOGIC (yogaja-pratyaksa)

subtle, distant, past or future objects, for the perfected practitioner

2023 Q6(c) ARE UNIVERSALS PERCEIVED? – THREE MOVES

FOR : determinate perception presents the object AS QUALIFIED by a
universal; contacts 3 and 5 exist to reach universals; without
perceptible kinds, classification and concomitance lose their base

AGAINST: ? universal-mediated perception may be ad hoc; exclusion (apoha)
explains classification without a perceived one-in-many; an object
not in present contact strains the definition of perception

VERDICT: justified WITHIN Nyaya's realist ontology; not justified for an
opponent who has refused it => metaphysical before perceptual

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/15: Inference engine – members, grids, five marks

reason (hetu/linga) = smoke | similar instance (sapaksa) = kitchen

dissimilar instance (vipaksa) = lake

FIVE MEMBERS (pancavayava) – THE PUBLIC FORM OF ONE REFLECTION

1 THESIS (pratijna) "the hill has fire" states the claim

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2 REASON (hetu) ..... "because it has smoke"      names the sign
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3 EXAMPLE (udaharana) .... "wherever smoke, fire - states the RULE + an
                             as in a kitchen" AGREED INSTANCE <<<<
```

4 APPLICATION (upanaya) .. "this hill has such smoke" brings subject under it

5 CONCLUSION (nigamana) .. "therefore the hill has fire" now ESTABLISHED

<<< member 3 has NO Aristotelian counterpart: Nyaya proves to a PERSON,
it does not test the form of a sentence.

members 3+4 = public form of SUBSUMPTIVE REFLECTION (paramarsa):

"this hill possesses smoke which is pervaded by fire" = IMMEDIATE CAUSE (karana) of the inferential cognition.

! redundancy objection: fewer members suffice for a trained hearer.

reply: the demonstration is a PUBLIC EPISTEMIC ACT, not a minimal derivation.

THREE CLASSIFICATION GRIDS – SAY WHICH ONE YOU ARE USING

by PURPOSE : for oneself (svarthanumana) | for another (pararthanumana)

by DIRECTION : cause->effect (purvavat, clouds to rain)
effect->cause (sesavat, swollen river to past rain)
non-causal uniformity (samanyatodrsta, celestial position)
! sesavat also read as RESIDUAL inference (parisesa)

by CONCOMITANCE : positive-only (kevalanvayi) | negative-only (kevalavyatireki)
| positive-and-negative (anvayavyatireki)

FIVE MARKS OF A VALID REASON

1 presence in the subject (paksadharmata)

2 presence in similar instances (sapaksa-sattva)

3 absence from dissimilar instances (vipaksa-asattva)

4 not contradicted (abadhita) 5 not counterbalanced (asatpratipaksa)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/15: Securing concomitance and the five fallacies

= invariable non-deviation (avinabhava-niyama). NOT mere frequency.

equal extension (samavyapti) = convertible

unequal extension (visamavyapti) = all smoke pervaded by fire, not conversely

ACQUISITION CHAIN – EACH STEP FIXES THE PREVIOUS STEP'S GAP (2022 Q7(c))

1 REPEATED OBSERVATION (bhuyodarsana): co-presence (anvaya) + co-absence (vyatireka) GAP: a finite sample stays finite

2 NON-OBSERVATION OF DEVIATION (vyabhicara-adarsana): search and fail to find a counter-case GAP: a hidden condition may still act

3 ADJUNCT-ELIMINATION (upadhi-nirasa)

FORMULA: sadhya-vyapakatve sati sadhana-avyapakah

= PERVADES the property to be proved, does NOT pervade the reason

WORKED CASE: bad inference "hill has smoke BECAUSE fire".

WET FUEL (ardra-indhana): wherever SMOKE, wet fuel -> pervades sadhya
not wherever FIRE, wet fuel -> not the hetu

=> fire does not unconditionally pervade smoke; the inference fails
plus removal of the SUSPICION of an adjunct (upadhi-sanka-nivrtti)

GAP: a residual "but what if?"

4 HYPOTHETICAL REASONING (tarka): contrary supposition -> unacceptable consequence. STATUS: AID ONLY => the reply is NOT circular

5 UNIVERSAL-MEDIATED PERCEPTION: the KIND is grasped, not the sample

! RESIDUE: the whole reply presupposes REALISM ABOUT UNIVERSALS.

! COUNTER-ATTACK: a universal denial of inference is itself a universal claim

(svavacana-virodha); the Carvaka's own hidden-adjunct argument is inferential

FIVE FALLACIES (hetvabhasa) MAPPED ONTO THE FIVE MARKS (2023 Q7(a))

IRREGULAR (savyabhicara/anaikantika) -> violates MARK 3

sadharana (in both classes) | asadharana (confined to the subject)

| anupasamharin (too wide for contrast)

UNPROVED (asiddha/sadhyasama) -----> violates MARK 1

asrayasiddha (unreal locus) | svarupasiddha (reason absent in subject)

| vyapyatvasiddha (pervasion unproved, typically an adjunct)

STULTIFIED (badhita/kalatita) -----> violates MARK 4 (fire inferred as cold)

COUNTERBALANCED (satpratipaksa/prakaranasama) -> violates MARK 5

CONTRADICTION (viruddha) -----> REVERSES CONCOMITANCE ITSELF

proves the opposite of the intended property (permanence -> impermanence)

! exactly five conditions => exactly five modes of failure, one of which operates on the relation rather than on a condition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/15: Comparison, testimony, memory, validity, fruit

COMPARISON (upamāna) IN FOUR BEATS – 2021-style semantic acquisition

- 1 forester says "a gavaya is like a cow" -> TESTIMONY gives a DESCRIPTION
- 2 you see such an animal -> PERCEPTION gives an OBJECT
- 3 you recall the description -> MEMORY reproduces
- 4 "THIS is what the word 'gavaya' denotes" -> COMPARISON: the WORD-OBJECT
RELATION, a new cognition

! not analogical argument. classical Vaisesika folds it into inference;
Nyaya resists because instruments are individuated by the KIND of cognition.

TESTIMONY (sabda) – 2021 Q5(b): THREE LIMBS ARE REQUIRED

SPEAKER: a reliable person (apta) = correct knowledge + truthful intention
+ competent expression. NOT status, NOT confidence.

SENTENCE: mutual expectancy (akanksa) | semantic fitness (yogyata)
| proximity (sannidhi/asatti) | intended meaning (tatparya)
example: "bring the saindhava" = salt at dinner, horse before a ride

RESULT: cognition of the word-object relation, hence of the object

CLASSES: perceptible (drstartha) / imperceptible (adrstartha);
secular (laukika) / Vedic (vaidika)

! Vedic authority linked in later Nyaya to GOD as omniscient author.
keep the scriptural proof a CONVERGING strand, not the foundation
-> otherwise circular (Veda proves God, God certifies Veda).

MEMORY (smṛti) EXCLUDED – TWO DIFFERENT GROUNDS, ONE VERDICT (2024 comparative)

NYAYA : lacks NOVELTY – reproduces, generates nothing new

PRABHAKARA : lacks PRESENTATIVE character – depends on a residual impression

VALIDITY (2025 comparative)

+-----+			
SCHOOL	VALIDITY	INVALIDITY	
NYAYA	EXTRINSIC (paratah)	EXTRINSIC (paratah)	
MIMAMSA	INTRINSIC (svatah)	extrinsic	
+-----+			

! TRAP: "Nyaya is extrinsic for invalidity" is only HALF the position.
reason: truth depends on defect-free generating conditions, to which the
knower has no internal access -> successful activity, coherence, corroboration

INSTRUMENT vs FRUIT (2025 Q5(b))

NYAYA : knower (pramatr) | instrument (pramana) | object (prameya)
| fruit (pramanaphala/pramiti) – FOUR DISTINCT FACTORS.
realism separates the reaching from what reaches (axe vs splitting)

BUDDHIST : Dignaga tightens them; cognition is both act and result in a
self-luminous framework; a distinct instrument would be an
unperceived second entity

=> the difference FOLLOWS FROM the opposed ontologies; it is not terminological

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/15: Error, self, mind and release

MISPLACEMENT THEORY OF ERROR (anyathakhyati) – SHELL-SILVER, STEP BY STEP

real shell present + real silver existing ELSEWHERE
-> glitter revives a past impression of silver
-> COGNITION-MEDIATED PERCEPTION (jñanalaksana-pratyakṣa) makes the silver
PRESENT TO AWARENESS without physical presence <- 2019 Q6(b) answer
-> NON-DISCRIMINATION fails to notice they are two
-> FALSE COGNITION "this is silver"
-> SUBLATION (badha): "this is NOT silver" – DENIES THE RELATION, not an
entity => realism survives; NOTHING UNREAL WAS EVER PERCEIVED

FIVE THEORIES OF ERROR, ORDERED BY ONTOLOGICAL COST

akhyati (Prabhakara Mīmāṃsā) ... two valid cognitions undiscriminated; there
is NO false cognition at all [cheapest]
anyathakhyati (Nyāya) two reals, one bad relation
atmakhyati (Yogācāra) internal cognition projected outward
anirvacanīya-khyati (Advaita) .. object NEITHER real NOR unreal
asatkhyati (Madhyamika, standard doxography) apprehension of the non-existent
2021 ROUTED REPLY: a third ontological status is obscure and uneconomical.
! Advaita counters: the silver is sublated (so not real) yet motivating
(so not unreal). Nyāya answers both facts with location, not status.
! Nyāya vs Prabhakara: "this is NOT silver" denies something ASSERTED, so a
theory with no false cognition cannot explain the corrective form.

SELF (ātman): eternal, ALL-PERVADING, MANY substances

consciousness is an ADVENTITIOUS QUALITY, not the self's essence (vs ADVAITA)
SIX MARKS (2024 Q5(b)) – iccā-dveṣa-prayātṇa-sukha-duḥkha-jñānāni ātmano
lingam: 1 desire 2 aversion 3 effort 4 pleasure 5 pain 6 cognition
6 is structurally different: cognition is a QUALITY, so it needs a SUBSTANCE
! SUPPLEMENTARY ONLY: memory/recognition; the instrument-user argument.
NEVER substitute them when "six reasons" is asked.
form: a NEGATIVE-ONLY (kevalavyatireki) inference – no independent
similar instance of a self is available

MIND (manas): eternal, ATOMIC, one per self => one cognition at a time;

deep sleep = mind withdrawn from conjunction, self persists uncognising

RELEASE (apavarga) = ABSOLUTE CESSATION OF PAIN (duḥkha-atyanta-nivṛtti)

NOT bliss. liberated self has no pleasure, pain, desire, aversion, cognition
STONE-LIKE OBJECTION -> REPLY: the aim is freedom FROM suffering, not the
acquisition of bliss; bliss is relational and can generate attachment
! RESIDUE: a motivational cost survives – a goal no one can desire AS a state

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/15: God and Udayana's cumulative case

God (nyaya), eternal, uncaused, only, BODILESS, special self, never bound by karma

EFFICIENT CAUSE (nimitta-karana) ONLY – atoms remain the MATERIAL cause

THREE JOBS: cosmic (conjoins atoms, working WITH the unseen moral force
adrsta) | moral (allots karmic fruit) | scriptural (source of the Veda)

UDAYANA'S PROOFS AS INFERENCES (2019 Q7(a)) – SUBJECT | REASON | PROPERTY

FROM EFFECT (karyat) the world | composite and ordered, hence an
effect | has an intelligent maker | pot & potter

FROM COMBINATION (ayojanat) primordial atomic conjunction | inert atoms and
unconscious adrsta cannot start ordered FIRST
motion | needs an intelligent impeller

FROM SUSTENANCE (dhrtyadeh) the ordered cosmos | sustained, regulated,
dissolved | needs governing intelligence

FROM SCRIPTURE (sruteh) ... Vedic sentences | require competent authorship,
scope exceeds ordinary knowledge | omniscient source

ALSO: padat (words) | pratyayatah (cognition) | vakyat (sentences)
| sankhyavisesat (numerical modes) | moral-administration strand

STRUCTURE: successive OBSTACLE-REMOVAL in the Nyayakusumanjali => a CUMULATIVE
case. ? names and counts vary: write "commonly enumerated as".

OBJECTIONS -> REPLIES -> RESIDUE

Mimamsa: authorless Veda + apurva -> omniscient apta explains better
| residue: grant authorlessness and the scriptural proof weakens

Samkhya: prakrti suffices, a perfect God has no motive -> unconscious prakrti
cannot allot karma | residue: the motive problem survives

Buddhist: DISANALOGY (vaisamya) – a potter has a body, hands, materials
-> embodiment is not essential to agency | residue: analogy strained

Carvaka: God unperceived, inference unreliable -> secure inference first

Advaita: God is only empirical (vyavaharika) -> reject the two-level downgrade

EVIL: fruits follow BEGINNINGLESS KARMA | residue: divine independence limited

! ALL objections land on ONE shared premiss: order and meaning require
intelligence rather than being brute or emergent.

2018 Q6(a) NYAYA vs YOGA – REASONED "NO"

NYAYA: God INFERRED as the explanation of cosmic and moral order

YOGA : a SPECIAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS (purusa-visesa) untouched by afflictions,
actions, fruits, deposits; ADMITTED within an existing soteriology;
role is practical – devotion (Isvara-pranidhana) aids absorption

=> sameness of NAME is not sameness of DEMONSTRATION or FUNCTION

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/15: Causation and atomism

CAUSATION: asatkaryavada / anabhavada – the effect is NEWLY PRODUCED

CAUSE = UNCONDITIONAL INVARIABLE ANTECEDENT: prior (purvavrtti), invariably prior (niyata-purvavrtti), NOT OTHERWISE ESTABLISHED (ananyathasiddha)

complete cause = causal complex (karana-samagri) + absence of a blocker

EXCLUDED (anyathasiddha) – 2020 Q6(c), five KINDS of irrelevance:

- staff-colour (quality of an instrument) | potter's father (remote)
- | staff-sound (co-effect) | space (omnipresent background)
- | donkey (accidental companion)

THREE CAUSES: inherent (samavayi) threads | non-inherent (asamavayi) their conjunction, a quality | efficient (nimitta) the weaver

2021 SEED/TREE: NO. specificity comes from INVARIABILITY, not latency.

2023 PRIOR ABSENCE: a real absence cannot coexist with a latent presence

! residue: presupposes real absences, which Samkhya need not grant

ATOMISM: atom (paramanu) eternal, partless, indivisible, imperceptible, minute (parimandalya). 2 atoms -> DYAD (dvyanuka, imperceptible)

3 DYADS -> TRIAD (tryanuka/trasarenu) = FIRST PERCEPTIBLE MAGNITUDE

! NOT three atoms. mote in a sunbeam is the standard illustration.

first motion at creation needs adrsta + divine will; cycles of creation

(srsti) and dissolution (pralaya); ATOMS PERSIST THROUGH DISSOLUTION

=> atomism's own gap is what makes the school theistic

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/15: Verdict grid, cross-school anchors, answer rail

THREE STIPULATED TERMINI – ALL CRITICISM CONVERGES HERE

inherence = self-linking (svarupa-sambandha)

particularity = self-differentiating (svato-vyavartaka)

universal-mediated perception = the kind is perceptually given

GRADED VERDICT

STRONG : the most developed Indian theory of inference, debate and fallacy
| a serious realist reply to inductive scepticism
| a REGULATED ontology (six blockers, reduction of instruments)
| the most rigorous Indian cumulative natural theology

WEAK : the three termini are asserted where explanation stops
| release without consciousness invites the stone-like objection
| God's independence limited by beginningless karma
| absence + inherence + particularity look like proliferation

CONTESTED? : universal-mediated perception as genuine perception
| one system or two
| whether an embodied-artisan analogy can prove a bodiless maker

CROSS-SCHOOL ANCHORS – ONE ROW PER RIVAL

vs CARVAKA : inference defended by adjunct-elimination + tarka + real kinds

vs BUDDHISM : real universals vs exclusion (apoha) | enduring self vs no-self
| real wholes vs aggregate reduction | instrument $\neq$ fruit

vs JAINISM : determinate categories vs non-absolutism and standpoints

vs SAMKHYA : new production vs pre-existent effect | God vs no creator

vs MIMAMSA : extrinsic validity vs intrinsic | authored vs authorless Veda
| Nyaya reduces postulation and non-cognition; Mimamsa does not

vs ADVAITA : misplacement vs the indefinable | consciousness as quality vs
as nature | many selves vs one | release as cessation vs bliss

vs YOGA : God inferred as cosmic cause vs admitted as meditative support

ANSWER RAIL – WHAT TO WRITE, IN ORDER

1 name the half of the system the question sits in (Nyaya / Vaishesika / joint)

2 define technically, with the English concept first and IAST immediately after

3 give the classification or the argument, with named evidence

4 add ONE named opponent and the reply

5 close: STRENGTH + COST + CONDITION, matched to the directive

CLOSING LINES BY MARK

10 : "strongest as a realist logic-ontology, but its primitive relations and
particularisers remain vulnerable."

15 : "the instruments secure knowledge, the categories secure being and God
secures order; inherence, particularity and unconscious release are
asserted as much as proved."

20 : "the very devices that make the system complete – inherence,
particularity, universal-mediated perception and a karma-bound God –
are also its deepest contested points."